

Cat Constant Meowing Fix — Action Checklist

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VERIFY MEDICAL CAUSES

- ☐ **Verify Medical Causes:** Request a T4 thyroid panel test to rule out hyperthyroidism, which causes increased vocalization in early stages before weight loss becomes apparent.
- ☐ **Verify Medical Causes:** Request an SDMA kidney biomarker test to check for early kidney disease, which commonly causes nighttime vocalization in cats of any age.
- ☐ **Verify Medical Causes:** Request a full chemistry panel to identify subtle abnormalities in liver function, electrolytes, and glucose that may be driving your cat's vocalization.
- ☐ **Verify Medical Causes:** Ask your vet to perform a joint pain assessment to check for arthritis, which causes cats to vocalize when jumping, stretching, or being moved.

IDENTIFY VOCALIZATION PATTERNS

- ☐ **Identify Vocalization Patterns:** Track your cat's meowing episodes for a minimum of 7 consecutive days, recording the time, location, and what was happening before each episode.
- ☐ **Identify Vocalization Patterns:** Record what you did in response to each meowing episode and how long it lasted to identify whether your reactions are accidentally reinforcing the behavior.
- ☐ **Identify Vocalization Patterns:** Identify whether your cat follows a pre-feeding, post-isolation, demand, or ambient anxiety vocalization pattern based on your tracking data.
- ☐ **Identify Vocalization Patterns:** Pinpoint what your cat gains from meowing: attention, food, play, comfort, or any reaction including negative responses, to identify the reward loop.

RETRAIN THE BEHAVIOR

- ☐ **Retrain the Behavior:** Implement extinction by completely removing reinforcement so your cat learns that meowing no longer produces any response, attention, or reward from you.

 - ☐ **Retrain the Behavior:** Introduce a replacement behavior by rewarding quiet calm with attention, treats, or play so your cat has an alternative to meowing that earns rewards.

 - ☐ **Retrain the Behavior:** Reduce ambient household stress using pheromone diffusers, maintaining consistent daily routines, and minimizing environmental changes that may contribute to anxiety.

 - ☐ **Retrain the Behavior:** Prepare for an extinction burst where meowing will temporarily intensify before improving, and commit to staying consistent so you don't quit right before success.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.